

Qualification Pack



Drone Software Technician

QP Code: SSC/Q8406

Version: 3.0

NSQF Level: 4

IT-ITeS SSC NASSCOM || NASSCOM Plot No - 7, 8, 9 & 10, 3rd Floor, Sector 126
Noida Uttar Pradesh - 201303 || email:sscstandards@nasscom.in

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SSC/Q8406: Drone Software Technician

Brief Job Description

The drone software technician will collaborate with stakeholders to document functional and non-functional requirements, create architectural diagrams that outline software structure, and design algorithms for navigation and flight control. . The technician will utilize simulation tools to test algorithms and validate software performance in controlled environments before conducting real-world flight tests. Thorough documentation of code and preparing software for deployment will also be key responsibilities, alongside updating it based on user feedback and technological advancements.

Personal Attributes

They must have a strong analytical mindset, attention to detail and a zeal to learn new things.

Applicable National Occupational Standards (NOS)

Compulsory NOS:

1. [SSC/N8435: Design the software for the Drone system](#)
2. [SSC/N8436: Conduct thorough testing of drone system software in both simulated environments and real-world scenarios to ensure reliability and safety](#)
3. [DGT/VSQ/N0102: Employability Skills \(60 Hours\)](#)

Qualification Pack (QP) Parameters

Sector	IT-ITeS
Sub-Sector	Future Skills
Occupation	Web & Mobile Development
Country	India
NSQF Level	4
Credits	13
Aligned to NCO/ISCO/ISIC Code	NCO-2015/NIL

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Minimum Educational Qualification & Experience	12th grade Pass (in STEM) OR 10th grade pass (in STEM) with 1.5 years of experience in relevant field. Relevant Experience in job roles related to Computer Programming/AI/IT/Analytics/Computer Science The relevant experience would include work, internship, and apprenticeship after completing relevant educational qualifications. OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (3) with 3 Years of experience in relevant field. Relevant Experience in job roles related to Computer Programming/AI/IT/Analytics/Computer Science The relevant experience would include work, internship, and apprenticeship after completing relevant educational qualifications.
Minimum Level of Education for Training in School	Not Applicable
Pre-Requisite License or Training	NA
Minimum Job Entry Age	18 Years
Last Reviewed On	NA
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Approval Date	08/05/2025
Version	3.0
Reference code on NQR	QG-04-IT-04332-2025-V2-NASSCOM & Version 3
NQR Version	3.0

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SSC/N8435: Design the software for the Drone system

Description

Design the software for the Drone system

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Design the software for the Drone system

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Collaborate with stakeholders to document functional (Flight control, Navigation, Payload integration, communication, Data logging ,mission planning etc.) and non-functional requirements (performance, scalability, security etc.)
- PC2.** Create architectural diagrams that outline the software components and their interactions, define the overall structure of the software, including modules for flight control, data processing, and user interface.
- PC3.** Design navigation algorithms (e.g., waypoints, obstacle avoidance, path planning).
- PC4.** Develop flight control algorithms to manage stabilization, speed, and performance parameters.
- PC5.** .Write the source code for each component, focusing on flight control, navigation, and data processing, utilize relevant programming languages (e.g., C++, Python, ROS) based on project requirements.
- PC6.** Ensure that the software is integrated with drone hardware components (e.g., sensors, GPS, motors).

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** The purpose and aims of the autonomous system being developed
- KU2.** Organizational policies, procedures and priorities for developing tests or simulations for hardware and software systems
- KU3.** Organization's knowledge base and how to access and update information on scenarios, test cases, scripts and tools
- KU4.** Who may need to involve when developing tests or simulations for hardware and software systems
- KU5.** Organizational policies and procedures for documenting simulations
- KU6.** The application and use of test or simulation tools
- KU7.** The approval process for testing of software and hardware systems
- KU8.** Experience with basic command line and coding with python

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- KU9.** MAVProxy Command Line Ground control Station knowledge and experience
- KU10.** Interpretation of business requirements and translate them to technical requirements
- KU11.** knowledge of Dronekit library for creation of Python scripts
- KU12.** Knowledge of MAVLink protocol
- KU13.** Knowledge of LUA Programming language for on-board software development

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Complete documentation accurately and write reports when required
- GS2.** read information accurately
- GS3.** read and interpret data sheets
- GS4.** Communicating with technical teams to collect requirements, describe product features and technical designs
- GS5.** Listen to and orally communicate information with all concerned
- GS6.** make appropriate decisions regarding the responsibilities of the job role
- GS7.** monitor efficient functioning of all activities
- GS8.** plan and organise work to achieve targets and deadlines
- GS9.** communicate with customers and other stakeholders in a courteous manner
- GS10.** maintain effective work relationship
- GS11.** identify trends/common causes for errors and suggest possible solutions to the supervisor / management
- GS12.** analyse best possible solutions (cost, time, effort, etc.) suited for operations
- GS13.** apply balanced judgments to different situations

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	50	-	20
PC1. Collaborate with stakeholders to document functional (Flight control, Navigation, Payload integration, communication, Data logging ,mission planning etc.) and non-functional requirements (performance, scalability, security etc.)	3	6	-	2
PC2. Create architectural diagrams that outline the software components and their interactions, define the overall structure of the software, including modules for flight control, data processing, and user interface.	3	6	-	2
PC3. Design navigation algorithms (e.g., waypoints, obstacle avoidance, path planning).	5	9	-	4
PC4. Develop flight control algorithms to manage stabilization, speed, and performance parameters.	5	9	-	4
PC5. .Write the source code for each component, focusing on flight control, navigation, and data processing, utilize relevant programming languages (e.g., C++, Python, ROS) based on project requirements.	7	10	-	4
PC6. Ensure that the software is integrated with drone hardware components (e.g., sensors, GPS, motors).	7	10	-	4
NOS Total	30	50	-	20

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	SSC/N8435
NOS Name	Design the software for the Drone system
Sector	IT-ITeS
Sub-Sector	Future Skills
Occupation	Web & Mobile Development
NSQF Level	4
Credits	6
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

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SSC/N8436: Conduct thorough testing of drone system software in both simulated environments and real-world scenarios to ensure reliability and safety

Description

This nos is about testing the drone software system

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Simulation testing
- Real world testing
- Debugging and Optimization
- Documentation
- Iterative development
- Deployment

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Employ simulation tools to test algorithms and flight control without physical hardware
- PC2.** Validate the behavior and performance of the software using a controlled virtual environment
- PC3.** Conduct flight tests to evaluate the software's performance in real-world conditions
- PC4.** Monitor system behavior, assess navigation accuracy, and verify data processing efficiency during flights
- PC5.** Identify and resolve any issues or bugs found during testing
- PC6.** Optimize algorithms for better performance, reliability, and responsiveness
- PC7.** Document the code, including usage instructions, algorithm explanations, and system architecture
- PC8.** Update and refine the software based on user inputs, testing results, and technology advancements
- PC9.** Prepare the software for deployment on the drone's onboard systems

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** The purpose and aims of the autonomous system being developed
- KU2.** Organizational policies, procedures and priorities for developing tests or simulations for hardware and software systems
- KU3.** Organization's knowledge base and how to access and update information on scenarios, test cases, scripts and tools

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- KU4.** Who may need to involve when developing tests or simulations for hardware and software systems
- KU5.** Organizational policies and procedures for documenting simulations
- KU6.** The application and use of test or simulation tools
- KU7.** The approval process for testing of software and hardware systems
- KU8.** Understanding and experience with Ardupilot autopilot software system
- KU9.** MAVProxy Command Line Ground control Station knowledge and experience
- KU10.** Understanding and experience with Gazebo simulator
- KU11.** knowledge of Dronekit library for creation of Python scripts
- KU12.** Knowledge of MAVLink protocol
- KU13.** Knowledge of LUA Programing language for on-board software development
- KU14.** Understanding and modelling of Simulink

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Complete documentation accurately and write reports when required
- GS2.** read information accurately
- GS3.** read and interpret data sheets
- GS4.** Communicating with technical teams to collect requirements, describe product features and technical designs
- GS5.** Listen to and orally communicate information with all concerned
- GS6.** make appropriate decisions regarding the responsibilities of the job role
- GS7.** monitor efficient functioning of all activities
- GS8.** plan and organise work to achieve targets and deadlines
- GS9.** communicate with customers and other stakeholders in a courteous manner
- GS10.** maintain effective work relationship
- GS11.** identify trends/common causes for errors and suggest possible solutions to the supervisor / management
- GS12.** analyse best possible solutions (cost, time, effort, etc.) suited for operations
- GS13.** apply balanced judgments to different situations

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	50	-	20
PC1. Employ simulation tools to test algorithms and flight control without physical hardware	2	4	-	1
PC2. Validate the behavior and performance of the software using a controlled virtual environment	2	4	-	1
PC3. Conduct flight tests to evaluate the software's performance in real-world conditions	4	5	-	1
PC4. Monitor system behavior, assess navigation accuracy, and verify data processing efficiency during flights	4	5	-	1
PC5. Identify and resolve any issues or bugs found during testing	5	8	-	4
PC6. Optimize algorithms for better performance, reliability, and responsiveness	2	6	-	3
PC7. Document the code, including usage instructions, algorithm explanations, and system architecture	2	6	-	3
PC8. Update and refine the software based on user inputs, testing results, and technology advancements	4	6	-	3
PC9. Prepare the software for deployment on the drone's onboard systems	5	6	-	3
NOS Total	30	50	-	20

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	SSC/N8436
NOS Name	Conduct thorough testing of drone system software in both simulated environments and real-world scenarios to ensure reliability and safety
Sector	IT-ITeS
Sub-Sector	Future Skills
Occupation	Web & Mobile Development
NSQF Level	4
Credits	5
Version	3.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

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DGT/VSQ/N0102: Employability Skills (60 Hours)

Description

This unit is about employability skills, Constitutional values, becoming a professional in the 21st Century, digital, financial, and legal literacy, diversity and Inclusion, English and communication skills, customer service, entrepreneurship, and apprenticeship, getting ready for jobs and career development.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Introduction to Employability Skills
- Constitutional values - Citizenship
- Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century
- Basic English Skills
- Career Development & Goal Setting
- Communication Skills
- Diversity & Inclusion
- Financial and Legal Literacy
- Essential Digital Skills
- Entrepreneurship
- Customer Service
- Getting ready for Apprenticeship & Jobs

Elements and Performance Criteria

Introduction to Employability Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** identify employability skills required for jobs in various industries
- PC2.** identify and explore learning and employability portals

Constitutional values – Citizenship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC3.** recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.
- PC4.** follow environmentally sustainable practices

Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC5.** recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment
- PC6.** practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life

Basic English Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

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- PC7.** use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone
- PC8.** read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English
- PC9.** write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English

Career Development & Goal Setting

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC10.** understand the difference between job and career
- PC11.** prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals, based on aptitude

Communication Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC12.** follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette and active listening techniques in various settings
- PC13.** work collaboratively with others in a team

Diversity & Inclusion

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC14.** communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD
- PC15.** escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act

Financial and Legal Literacy

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** select financial institutions, products and services as per requirement
- PC17.** carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely
- PC18.** identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc
- PC19.** identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation

Essential Digital Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC20.** operate digital devices and carry out basic internet operations securely and safely
- PC21.** use e- mail and social media platforms and virtual collaboration tools to work effectively
- PC22.** use basic features of word processor, spreadsheets, and presentations

Entrepreneurship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC23.** identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research
- PC24.** develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion
- PC25.** identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity

Customer Service

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC26.** identify different types of customers
- PC27.** identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner.

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PC28. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards

Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC29. create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)

PC30. search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively

PC31. apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement

PC32. answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection

PC33. identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

KU1. need for employability skills and different learning and employability related portals

KU2. various constitutional and personal values

KU3. different environmentally sustainable practices and their importance

KU4. Twenty first (21st) century skills and their importance

KU5. how to use English language for effective verbal (face to face and telephonic) and written communication in formal and informal set up

KU6. importance of career development and setting long- and short-term goals

KU7. about effective communication

KU8. POSH Act

KU9. Gender sensitivity and inclusivity

KU10. different types of financial institutes, products, and services

KU11. how to compute income and expenditure

KU12. importance of maintaining safety and security in offline and online financial transactions

KU13. different legal rights and laws

KU14. different types of digital devices and the procedure to operate them safely and securely

KU15. how to create and operate an e- mail account and use applications such as word processors, spreadsheets etc.

KU16. how to identify business opportunities

KU17. types and needs of customers

KU18. how to apply for a job and prepare for an interview

KU19. apprenticeship scheme and the process of registering on apprenticeship portal

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

GS1. read and write different types of documents/instructions/correspondence

GS2. communicate effectively using appropriate language in formal and informal settings

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- GS3.** behave politely and appropriately with all
- GS4.** how to work in a virtual mode
- GS5.** perform calculations efficiently
- GS6.** solve problems effectively
- GS7.** pay attention to details
- GS8.** manage time efficiently
- GS9.** maintain hygiene and sanitization to avoid infection

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Introduction to Employability Skills</i>	1	1	-	-
PC1. identify employability skills required for jobs in various industries	-	-	-	-
PC2. identify and explore learning and employability portals	-	-	-	-
<i>Constitutional values – Citizenship</i>	1	1	-	-
PC3. recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.	-	-	-	-
PC4. follow environmentally sustainable practices	-	-	-	-
<i>Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century</i>	2	4	-	-
PC5. recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment	-	-	-	-
PC6. practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life	-	-	-	-
<i>Basic English Skills</i>	2	3	-	-
PC7. use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone	-	-	-	-
PC8. read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English	-	-	-	-
PC9. write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English	-	-	-	-
<i>Career Development & Goal Setting</i>	1	2	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC10. understand the difference between job and career	-	-	-	-
PC11. prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals, based on aptitude	-	-	-	-
<i>Communication Skills</i>	2	2	-	-
PC12. follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette and active listening techniques in various settings	-	-	-	-
PC13. work collaboratively with others in a team	-	-	-	-
<i>Diversity & Inclusion</i>	1	2	-	-
PC14. communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD	-	-	-	-
PC15. escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act	-	-	-	-
<i>Financial and Legal Literacy</i>	2	3	-	-
PC16. select financial institutions, products and services as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC17. carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely	-	-	-	-
PC18. identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc	-	-	-	-
PC19. identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation	-	-	-	-
<i>Essential Digital Skills</i>	3	4	-	-
PC20. operate digital devices and carry out basic internet operations securely and safely	-	-	-	-
PC21. use e- mail and social media platforms and virtual collaboration tools to work effectively	-	-	-	-
PC22. use basic features of word processor, spreadsheets, and presentations	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Entrepreneurship</i>	2	3	-	-
PC23. identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research	-	-	-	-
PC24. develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion	-	-	-	-
PC25. identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity	-	-	-	-
<i>Customer Service</i>	1	2	-	-
PC26. identify different types of customers	-	-	-	-
PC27. identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner.	-	-	-	-
PC28. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards	-	-	-	-
<i>Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs</i>	2	3	-	-
PC29. create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)	-	-	-	-
PC30. search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively	-	-	-	-
PC31. apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC32. answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection	-	-	-	-
PC33. identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	20	30	-	-

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	DGT/VSQ/N0102
NOS Name	Employability Skills (60 Hours)
Sector	Cross Sectoral
Sub-Sector	Professional Skills
Occupation	Employability
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	12/03/2026
Next Review Date	12/03/2029
NSQC Clearance Date	12/03/2026

Assessment Guidelines and Assessment Weightage

Assessment Guidelines

The assessment will consist of a blend of hands-on practical evaluations, viva-voce, and online proctored scenario-based multiple-choice questions ensuring a thorough evaluation of the individual's proficiency in learning outcomes, practical understanding, and real-world application of concepts.

Minimum Aggregate Passing % at QP Level : 70

(Please note: Every Trainee should score a minimum aggregate passing percentage as specified above, to successfully clear the Qualification Pack assessment.)

Assessment Weightage

Compulsory NOS

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National Occupational Standards	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks	Total Marks	Weightage
SSC/N8435.Design the software for the Drone system	30	50	-	20	100	40
SSC/N8436.Conduct thorough testing of drone system software in both simulated environments and real-world scenarios to ensure reliability and safety	30	50	-	20	100	40
DGT/VSQ/N0102.Employability Skills (60 Hours)	20	30	-	-	50	20
Total	80	130	-	40	250	100

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Acronyms

NOS	National Occupational Standard(s)
NSQF	National Skills Qualifications Framework
QP	Qualifications Pack
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training

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Glossary

Sector	Sector is a conglomeration of different business operations having similar business and interests. It may also be defined as a distinct subset of the economy whose components share similar characteristics and interests.
Sub-sector	Sub-sector is derived from a further breakdown based on the characteristics and interests of its components.
Occupation	Occupation is a set of job roles, which perform similar/ related set of functions in an industry.
Job role	Job role defines a unique set of functions that together form a unique employment opportunity in an organisation.
Occupational Standards (OS)	OS specify the standards of performance an individual must achieve when carrying out a function in the workplace, together with the Knowledge and Understanding (KU) they need to meet that standard consistently. Occupational Standards are applicable both in the Indian and global contexts.
Performance Criteria (PC)	Performance Criteria (PC) are statements that together specify the standard of performance required when carrying out a task.
National Occupational Standards (NOS)	NOS are occupational standards which apply uniquely in the Indian context.
Qualifications Pack (QP)	QP comprises the set of OS, together with the educational, training and other criteria required to perform a job role. A QP is assigned a unique qualifications pack code.
Unit Code	Unit code is a unique identifier for an Occupational Standard, which is denoted by an 'N'
Unit Title	Unit title gives a clear overall statement about what the incumbent should be able to do.
Description	Description gives a short summary of the unit content. This would be helpful to anyone searching on a database to verify that this is the appropriate OS they are looking for.
Scope	Scope is a set of statements specifying the range of variables that an individual may have to deal with in carrying out the function which have a critical impact on quality of performance required.

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Knowledge and Understanding (KU)	Knowledge and Understanding (KU) are statements which together specify the technical, generic, professional and organisational specific knowledge that an individual needs in order to perform to the required standard.
Organisational Context	Organisational context includes the way the organisation is structured and how it operates, including the extent of operative knowledge managers have of their relevant areas of responsibility.
Technical Knowledge	Technical knowledge is the specific knowledge needed to accomplish specific designated responsibilities.
Core Skills/ Generic Skills (GS)	Core skills or Generic Skills (GS) are a group of skills that are the key to learning and working in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment. In the context of the OS, these include communication related skills that are applicable to most job roles.
Electives	Electives are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as contributive to specialization in a job role. There may be multiple electives within a QP for each specialized job role. Trainees must select at least one elective for the successful completion of a QP with Electives.
Options	Options are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as additional skills. There may be multiple options within a QP. It is not mandatory to select any of the options to complete a QP with Options.